

Project: Bharat Launch- Faculty Manual

Simulation Overview:

Project: Bharat Launch is an advanced business analytics simulation designed for MBA students at Taxila Business School. Students take on the role of a Product Manager launching a new Direct-to-Consumer (D2C) Smart Nutrition drink in the Indian market. The simulation spans 3 virtual years (12 quarters), starting with a crucial market research phase (Quarter 0) and progressing through launch and operational decision-making.

Students must analyze simulated market data, make strategic decisions based on the 4Ps (Product, Price, Place, Promotion), manage budgets, and react to dynamic market events. Success is measured by cumulative profit, market share, brand awareness, and an overall score benchmarked against a target.

Core Learning Outcomes:

Upon successful completion of this simulation, students will be able to:

1. Market Research & Segmentation:

- Analyze demographic and psychographic data to identify viable target market segments.
- Utilize filters (location, income, age) to query a database and understand segment characteristics (size, price sensitivity, brand consciousness, media habits, purchase drivers).
- Interpret city-specific data (population, PCI, competition) to inform market selection and strategy.
- (Optional) Design and evaluate the efficacy of custom market research questions using qualitative assessment.
- (Optional) Leverage AI-driven insights (Gemini survey analysis) to refine understanding beyond quantitative data.

2. Strategic Decision Making (4Ps):

- Formulate a cohesive marketing strategy by integrating decisions across Product, Price, Place, and Promotion.
- Understand the trade-offs in product design (Quality, Taste, Packaging) and their impact on Cost of Goods Sold (COGS).
- Set appropriate pricing strategies considering COGS, competitor pricing, and segment price sensitivity (adhering to the <15% rule).
- Select effective distribution channels (Place) based on target segment characteristics and geographical tiers (T1/T2/T3).
- Allocate a marketing budget (Promotion) and determine an effective marketing mix (Digital, Influencer, TV, Print/OOH) aligned with target segment media consumption.

3. **Financial Acumen & Budgeting:**
 - Understand the relationship between product decisions, COGS, pricing, and profit margins.
 - Manage a marketing budget effectively across different channels.
 - Analyze quarterly financial results (Revenue, Costs, Profit) to evaluate strategic performance.
 - Recognize the impact of fixed costs (distribution, market events) on overall profitability.
4. **Forecasting & Projection:**
 - Develop sales projections based on market research data and strategic assumptions.
 - Compare actual sales results against initial projections to assess forecasting accuracy.
5. **Data Analysis & Interpretation:**
 - Interpret quarterly reports detailing financial performance, market share gains, brand awareness levels, and customer analysis (segment performance).
 - Use performance data to iteratively refine strategic decisions in subsequent quarters.
6. **Adaptability & Problem Solving:**
 - Analyze the impact of dynamic market events (competitor actions, supply chain issues, PR, economic shifts) on performance.
 - Adjust strategic decisions in response to unforeseen market changes and performance feedback.

Simulation Flow:

1. **Welcome & Setup:** Student enters their name.
2. **Quarter 0 - Research & Analysis:**
 - **Objective:** Understand the market landscape and identify target segments.
 - **Tools:**
 - **Market Research Database:** Filter data by City, Income, Age. Analyze segment size, average metrics (income, price sensitivity, brand consciousness), key drivers, top media, and raw data samples. View City Profile data.
 - **Gemini Custom Survey (Optional):** Design 5 questions, check efficacy (heuristic analysis), run the survey on the filtered segment (deducts from Survey Budget), receive AI-generated insights.
 - **Budget:** Dedicated ₹1 Crore Survey Budget.
 - **Outcome:** Students gather data to inform their strategy. They click "Proceed to Projection Phase".
3. **Quarter 0 - Projection:**
 - **Objective:** Based on Q0 research, forecast unit sales for Q1, Q2, Q3, and Q4.
 - **Action:** Enter projections and click "Lock Projections & LAUNCH".
 - **Outcome:** Projections are locked. Q1 begins. The main 4P decision panel becomes active.
4. **Quarter 1 - 12 - Operations:**

- **Objective:** Implement and refine the 4P strategy quarter-by-quarter to maximize profit and score.
- **Cycle:**
 - Review previous quarter's results (Results Log).
 - Note the new Dynamic Market Event.
 - Adjust 4P decisions (Product sliders, Price input, Place checkboxes, Promotion budget slider & mix sliders).
 - (Optional) Run standard database queries (no cost after Q0). Custom surveys are disabled.
 - Click "End Quarter & Run Simulation".
 - View 4-second simulation delay bar.
 - Results are calculated and added to the log. Dashboard updates. New market event appears.
- **Game End Conditions:** Reaching Q13 (Completed 3 Years) OR Cash dropping to ₹0 or below (Bankrupt).

Key Decisions Explained:

- **Product:** Allocate 100 points between Quality, Taste, and Packaging. Higher points increase COGS but may appeal more to certain segments (e.g., high income, quality-driven). Lower points reduce COGS but might hurt sales. COGS Formula: $50 + (\text{Quality} * 0.8) + (\text{Taste} * 0.5) + (\text{Packaging} * 0.3)$.
- **Price:** Set the selling price per unit. Must consider COGS for margin. **Crucial Rule:** If $\text{Price} > 115\%$ of the *average competitor price in a specific city*, the probability of purchase in that city drops significantly (simulating consumer rejection).
- **Place (Distribution):** Select channels (checkboxes). Each channel has an associated quarterly fixed cost and varying effectiveness based on city tier and customer profile (e.g., D2C/Online better for T1/High Income, Kirana better for T2/T3).
 - D2C Online: Low cost, targets tech-savvy/T1.
 - E-Marketplaces: Medium cost, broad reach.
 - Supermarkets (T1): High cost, good for T1 reach.
 - Kirana Stores (T2/3): High cost, essential for T2/T3 reach.
- **Promotion:**
 - **Total Budget:** Set via slider (₹1M to ₹10 Cr per quarter). Higher budgets generally increase brand awareness faster, impacting purchase probability.
 - **Marketing Mix:** Allocate 100% of the budget across Digital, Influencer, TV, Print/OOH. Effectiveness depends on the target segment's "Top Media" preference identified in research. Aligning the mix with the target audience is key.

Metrics & Scoring:

- **Quarter:** Tracks simulation progress (0-12).
- **Survey Budget (Q0):** Starts at ₹1 Cr, depleted by custom surveys. Disappears after Q0.
- **Live Score:** Calculated based on cumulative profit against a target $((\text{Total Profit} / 15 \text{ Cr}) * 100)$, clamped between 0 and 100. This is the primary success metric.
- **Total Profit:** Cumulative profit/loss over all operational quarters.

- **Market Share:** Percentage of the total market potential captured by the student's product.
- **Brand Awareness:** Percentage reflecting how well-known the brand is. Influences initial purchase probability. Grows with marketing spend, decays slightly over time if underspent.

Dynamic Market Events:

Each quarter (Q1-Q12), a random event occurs, influencing calculations for that quarter. Examples:

- Competitor actions (affect purchase probability).
- Supply chain issues (increase COGS).
- Regulatory changes (increase fixed costs).
- Positive PR (boost brand awareness gain).
- Economic shifts (affect overall purchase probability). Students must read the event text and consider its potential impact when making decisions.

Debriefing & Evaluation:

At the end of the simulation (Q13 or Bankruptcy), two modals appear:

1. **Player Debriefing Report:**
 - Shows Final Score, Total Profit, Peak Market Share, Peak Brand Awareness.
 - Compares Year 1 Projections vs. Actual Sales.
 - Provides dynamically generated suggestions for improvement based on performance (e.g., projection accuracy, profitability issues, pricing errors, lack of custom survey use).
 - Allows download as a .txt file.
2. **Certificate of Completion:**
 - Displays Player Name, Final Score, and outcome message.
 - Allows download as a .png file via html2canvas.
 - Provides a pre-filled LinkedIn sharing link.

Faculty should use the Debriefing Report as a primary tool for discussion. Key points:

- How accurate were their initial projections? Why the deviation?
- Did their chosen 4P strategy align with their Q0 research?
- How did they adapt to market events?
- What was the relationship between their spending, pricing, and profitability?
- What would they do differently next time based on the suggestions?

Tips for Faculty:

- **Pre-Simulation Briefing:** Explain the goals, the interface, the 4Ps, the importance of Q0 research, and the scoring mechanism. Emphasize the 15% pricing rule.

- **During Simulation:** Encourage students to take notes on their decisions and rationale each quarter. Check in on their progress, perhaps after Q4 and Q8. Avoid giving direct strategic advice, but help them find relevant data in the simulation if they are stuck.
- **Post-Simulation Debrief:** Facilitate a discussion using the Debriefing Report. Have students share their strategies, successes, and failures. Compare results if multiple students/teams played. Connect the simulation outcomes to relevant marketing and strategy concepts taught in the course.
- **Technical:** Ensure students are using a modern browser (Chrome/Firefox recommended). The simulation relies on JavaScript and specific browser features (html2canvas for PNG download).

This manual provides a comprehensive guide to understanding, facilitating, and debriefing the Project: Bharat Launch simulation.